Informed Consent for Interview

Dear Participant,

We are student researchers in the Bachelor of Science in Information Technology program at Southwestern University-PHINMA. We are conducting this capstone study:

Architecting a Lightweight Cloud-Based Inventory and Financial Management System: A Mixed-Methods Evaluation of Decision-Making Efficiency in Philippine SMEs

The study examines inventory and financial recordkeeping in Philippine small and medium enterprises and evaluates Kodigo, a cloud-based inventory and financial management system.

What taking part involves

A researcher will ask up to 11 guided questions about your usual workflow, stock discrepancies, financial reconciliation, and decision-making. The interview is expected to take about 30 to 45 minutes. You may skip any question. Please do not share passwords, customer records, or business details you consider confidential.

Possible risks and benefits

No direct benefit is promised. Questions about operational problems may feel sensitive. You can skip a question or stop the interview. Your experience may help the researchers describe SME workflows and evaluate where Kodigo could support recordkeeping.

Audio recording

The interviewer will take written notes. Audio recording is optional. Your choice will not affect your participation; if you do not agree, the interviewer will rely on written notes.

Recording permission: [ ] I agree to audio recording [ ] I do not agree

Voluntary participation and withdrawal

Taking part is voluntary. You may decline, skip questions, or stop without penalty or effect on your relationship with the university or your business. You may ask the team to withdraw your interview before your notes or transcript are de-identified and included in combined analysis. After that, the team may not be able to identify your answers.

Privacy and use of information

The researchers will omit your name and business name from the thesis and use a participant code for working records. The thesis may include short quotations without identifying details. Interview notes, transcripts, any audio file, and this signed form will be stored securely with access limited to the research team and academic adviser. The consent form will be stored separately from interview notes. Any audio file will be deleted after the transcript is checked; other records will be retained and disposed of under university research requirements.

Researcher contacts

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Agreement

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I have read or had this form explained to me and had a chance to ask questions. I understand that taking part is voluntary, that I may skip questions or withdraw as described, and that audio recording is optional and based on my separate choice above. I freely agree to take part in this interview.

Participant name (print): _____

Participant signature: _____ Date: _____

Person obtaining consent: _____ Date: _____